

SAUD ABDULLAH ALAREEFI

CYBERSECURITY | SECURITY OPERATIONS | PENETRATION TESTING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity-focused Network Engineering graduate with a 6-month Ministry of Commerce internship rotating across three specializations: Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC), Vulnerability Assessment (VA), and Security Operations Center (SOC). Uses Splunk and Microsoft Sentinel for SIEM and security event monitoring. Holds 7 cybersecurity credentials, including Microsoft Certified: Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200) and TryHackMe PT1, with credential-backed knowledge of incident response and threat hunting. Achieved a #30 global FlagYard ranking, secured 3rd Place in the Cybersecurity Track of the AMAD Fintech Hackathon, and built an SDN security project covering five attack categories.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & AWARDS

- Secured 3rd Place in the Cybersecurity Track of the AMAD Fintech Hackathon, organized by alinma Bank in partnership with Tuwaiq Academy (2025).
- Achieved a #30 global ranking on the FlagYard cybersecurity platform.
- Reached the Black Hat MEA CTF Finals in two consecutive years — 2024 and 2025.
- Competed in the Aramco Cybersecurity CTF.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: SOC, security operations analysis, incident response, threat hunting, SIEM monitoring, Splunk, Microsoft Sentinel, security event monitoring, threat analysis, incident investigation

Security Testing: Vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, Kali Linux

Governance & Engineering: GRC, network security, Software-Defined Networking (SDN), Cloud-IoT security

Programming & Data: Python, PHP, MySQL, Random Forest classification

EXPERIENCE

Cyber Security Trainee | Ministry of Commerce | Jul 2025 – Dec 2025

- Completed a 6-month rotational government cybersecurity internship across three specializations: GRC, Vulnerability Assessment (VA), and SOC.
- SOC: Used SIEM platforms, including Splunk and Microsoft Sentinel, for security event monitoring and incident investigation.
- VA: Executed vulnerability assessments and penetration testing activities to identify and document security weaknesses.
- GRC: Reviewed governance, risk, and compliance concepts and frameworks and prepared structured security reports documenting findings and remediation recommendations.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Network Engineering | Mustaqbal University | Graduated June 2026

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA | Security+, Cybersecurity Analyst (CySA+)

INE Security / eLearnSecurity | Junior Penetration Tester (eJPT); Certified Professional Penetration Tester (eCPPT); Web Application Penetration Tester eXtreme (eWPTX)

TryHackMe | Jr Penetration Tester (PT1) | Microsoft Certified | Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200)

PROJECTS

Deep Learning–Enhanced SDN Security Framework | Graduation Project | 2025

- In 2025, developed a security model for Cloud-IoT networks with Software-Defined Networking (SDN).
- Implemented a Random Forest classifier across five attack categories to detect attacks and analyze network traffic.

Online Customer Support System | 2024

- In 2024, built a web-based customer support platform with PHP and MySQL to manage user inquiries and support workflows.

STUDENT LEADERSHIP (PART-TIME)

Part-time student activities completed alongside university studies: Student Council Leader (Mar 2022 – Jun 2025) | Student Club Leader (Jan 2024 – Sep 2025)

STUDENT PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

KSU Cyber Security Club, PR Team Member | Jan 2024 – May 2025

LANGUAGES

Arabic | English